

Typica. Unchanging parts, with rubrics, from the Horologion

When a priest is not present in order to celebrate the Divine Liturgy

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The translation used is primarily that of Fr. Lawrence of Jordanville. The order of service is based primarily on the Reader Service Typikon by Bishop Daniel (the Old Rite Bishop of the ROCA) and translated by Fr. George Lardas. All the psalms are from The Psalter According to the Seventy, © Copyright Holy Transfiguration Monastery, Brookline, MA, used by permission. Some other material, such as prayers and hymns, are also Copyright HTM, used by permission. All rights reserved. These works may not be further reproduced, beyond printing out a single copy for personal non-commercial use, without the prior written authorization of Holy Transfiguration Monastery.

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Notes:

The Typica is a service that has two purposes. There are some days of the year with the Typica is served before some Special Divine or Presanctified liturgies, in Great Lent or Holy Week, and some other times during the year. This typical service, below does not apply to this purpose.

Its major purpose is to serve as a substitute when Divine Liturgy cannot be served on the day it normally would be served, such as Sunday. It is the perfect service for lay people to use when they are not able to attend the Divine Liturgy.

Its format is basically that of a shortened Divine liturgy, taking out all the parts that cannot be served without a priest. All of the ectenias, which are the prayers that are said by the deacon or the priest and answered by the choir, such as “In peace let us pray to the Lord”, which the choir answers: “Lord have mercy”, are omitted. All of the parts of the liturgy that have to do with the consecration of the bread and the wine into the body and blood of Christ are also omitted. The small entrance, which occurs just before the reading of the Epistle and Gospel, and the Great Entrance, in which the bread and the wine, are brought from the table of preparation to the altar, are omitted. Basically, what is left is the sung hymns.

If a person knows how to sing the hymns, it is good to sing them. It does not matter if you do not know how to sing the hymns; in this case, just chant them. A person learns how to chant by listening to others chant. If you’re not sure and have not been able to listen to someone, then just read them, without embellishing anything. Whether we sing, or chant, or just read, we should concentrate on making our voice understandable, and not interjecting our own emotions and opinions into the text. This is a learned thing. Don’t be upset if you feel awkward at first. Nobody gets good at something without not being good at it first.

Every Divine Liturgy begins with the blessing by the priest, and then the great Ectenia which consists of multiple petitions which are answered by the choir, and then three “antiphons”.

The Typica will begin with a blessing, which is modified. When a layman says something in place of the priests blessing, he will usually say: “Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.”

In place of the Ectenia the “Trisagion prayers” are then said.

The antiphons are “introduced” by a common sequence that is in many Orthodox services, which, however, is not in the Divine liturgy. It is “Lord have mercy”, repeated 12 times, then “Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever and unto the ages of ages, amen”, and then the three lined hymn, “O come let us worship...”. After this, the antiphons are said exactly as they are in liturgy. In the Divine liturgy, after each antiphon there will be a “small litany”, which is omitted in the Typica. That means that the three antiphons are sung one right after the other.

The small entrance is omitted, but the entry hymn, which occurs at the very end of the Small Entrance in the Divine liturgy, is included in the Typica.

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In the Divine liturgy, after this many Troparia and Kontakia are sung. In the Typica, at this point, only the appointed Troparia are sung.

This is the point in the Divine Liturgy where the Epistle and Gospel are read, with their accompanying hymns before and after. In the Typica all of these are included, but any place where the priest would say “Wisdom!” or “Let us attend” is omitted.

After the Scripture readings, in the Divine liturgy, there may be a sermon, and it would be appropriate to read one here as well, or at the end of the service. This is optional.

The rest of the Divine liturgy is almost completely dedicated to the consecration of the gifts. All of these specific prayers are omitted.

Therefore, we immediately then say the “Symbol of Faith” (the Creed), and then sing the appointed Kontakia. To be perfectly honest with you, I am not sure why they’re not just included where they would occur in their regular place in the Divine liturgy, which would be combined with the Troparia. It would not be a crime to include them there, but the Typica calls for them to be included after the (Creed) is said.

We finish the Typica with Psalm 33, which is generally sung at the end of the Divine liturgy, often when the priest is consuming the holy gifts. Then we sing the Megalynarion, as sung at Divine liturgy, however in the Typica we sing it is the last hymn, and in the Divine liturgy it is sung immediately after the consecration is finished.

The Usual Beginning:

If Typica is not preceded immediately by the hours, begin with the "usual beginning" ("Through the prayers of our holy fathers..."; the Trisagion, "Lord, have mercy!" (x12); "Glory...Both now...", and then "O Come let us worship" (see below).

Beginning blessing

Senior Reader: **Through the prayers of our holy fathers, Lord Jesus Christ our God, have mercy on us. Amen.**

Note: during the time of Pascha, (from Pascha until the Ascension), we first sing the Troparion for Pascha, "Christ is risen...", Three times, then we say the Trisagion prayers.

Trisagion Prayers

Reader: Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal, have mercy on us. *(Thrice)*

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

O Most Holy Trinity, have mercy on us. O Lord, blot out our sins. O Master, pardon our iniquities. O Holy One, visit and heal our infirmities for Thy name's sake.

Lord, have mercy. *(Thrice)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Our Father, Who art in the Heavens, hallowed be Thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, Thy will be done, on earth as it is in Heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

Lord, have mercy. *(Twelve times)*

Glory to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

O Come let us worship... *(see below)*

Otherwise, after the conclusion of the 6th hour, we begin Typica as follows:

O Come let us worship

O come let us worship God our King.

O come let us worship and fall down before Christ our King and God.

O come let us worship and fall down before Christ Himself, our King and God.

If between Pascha and its leave-taking (the day before Ascension), we sing “Christ is risen” 3 times, instead of “O come let us worship”)

Christ is risen from the dead, trampling down death by death, and on those in the tombs, bestowing life. *(Thrice)*

The First Antiphon

Note: The festal antiphons can be used in place of the typical psalms, as at a liturgy, when they are appointed. There are festal antiphons for Pascha, and all of the great feast of the Lord, such as the Nativity, Transfiguration, and theophany, and others.

Bless the Lord, O my soul; blessed art Thou, O Lord. * Bless the Lord, O my soul, and all that is within me bless His holy name. * Bless the Lord, O my soul, and forget not all that He hath done for thee. * Who is gracious unto all thine iniquities, Who healeth all thine infirmities. * Who redeemeth thy life from corruption, Who crowneth thee with mercy and compassion. * Who fulfilleth thy desire with good things; thy youth shall be renewed as the eagle's. * The Lord performeth deeds of mercy, and executeth judgment for all them that are wronged. * He hath made His ways known unto Moses, unto the sons of Israel the things that He hath willed. * Compassionate and merciful is the Lord, long-suffering and plenteous in mercy. * Not unto the end will He be angered, neither unto eternity will He be wroth. * Not according to our iniquities hath He dealt with us, neither according to our sins hath He rewarded us. * For according to the height of heaven from the earth, the Lord hath made His mercy to prevail over them that fear Him. * As far as the east is from the west, so far hath He removed our iniquities from us. * Like as a father hath compassion upon his sons, so hath the Lord had compassion upon them that fear Him; * for He knoweth whereof we are made, He hath remembered that we are dust. * As for man, his days are as the grass; as a flower of the field, so shall he blossom forth. * For when the wind is passed over it, then it shall be gone, and no longer will it know the place thereof. * But the mercy of the Lord is from eternity, even unto eternity, upon them that fear Him. * And His righteousness is upon sons of sons, upon them that keep His testament and remember His commandments to do them. * The Lord in heaven hath prepared His throne, and His kingdom ruleth over all. * Bless the Lord, all ye His angels, mighty in strength, that perform His word, to hear the voice of His words. * Bless the Lord, all ye His hosts, His ministers that do His will. * Bless the Lord, all ye His works, in every place of His dominion.

Glory to the Father, * and to the Son, * and to the Holy Spirit. * Both now and ever, * and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Bless the Lord, O my soul, * and all that is within me * bless His holy name; * blessed art Thou, O Lord.

The Second Antiphon

Glory to the Father, * and to the Son, * and to the Holy Spirit. * Praise the Lord, O my soul. I will praise the Lord in my life, I will chant unto my God for as long as I have my being. * Trust ye not in princes, in the sons of men, in whom there is no salvation. * His spirit shall go forth, and he shall return unto his earth. In that day all his thoughts shall perish. * Blessed is he of whom the God of Jacob is his help, whose hope is in the Lord his God, * Who hath made heaven and the earth, the sea and all that is therein. * Who keepeth truth unto eternity, Who executeth judgment for the wronged, Who giveth food unto the hungry. * The Lord looseth the fettered; the Lord maketh wise the blind; the Lord setteth aright the fallen; * the Lord loveth the righteous; the Lord preserveth the proselytes. * He shall adopt for His own the orphan and widow, and the way of sinners shall He destroy. * The Lord shall be king unto eternity; thy God, O Zion, unto generation and generation.

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

O only-begotten Son and Word of God, Who art immortal, yet didst deign for our salvation to be incarnate of the Holy Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary, and without change didst become man, and was crucified, O Christ God, trampling down death by death. Thou Who art one of the Holy Trinity, glorified with the Father and the Holy Spirit, save us.

Third Antiphon

The Third antiphon is sung by singing a verse from the Beatitudes from Matthew's gospel, and then adding a hymn that is specific to the day being celebrated. If there are two people, it's very useful to have one person saying the verses from the Beatitudes, and another to sing the hymns. Alternatively, people know how to sing together everybody can sing it together. If you don't sing, then you may chant this.

Note: Troparia are read between these verses, as appointed by the typikon.

The Troparion maybe chanted or read. Chanting is basically like "reading", but it is a little bit melodic. You will sing with one or two notes. If this is difficult, just read the troparion. It is customary to try to read or chant without giving your own emotional interpretation. This takes a little practice.

In Thy kingdom remember us, O Lord, * when Thou comest in Thy kingdom.

Blessed are the poor in spirit, * for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

[If there are 12 troparia, the first one should be sung (or chanted) now.]

Blessed are they that mourn, * for they shall be comforted.

Blessed are the meek, * for they shall inherit the earth.

[If there are 10 troparia, the first one should be chanted (read)now.]

Blessed are they that hunger and thirst after righteousness, * for they shall be filled.

Blessed are the merciful, * for they shall obtain mercy.

[If there are 8 troparia verses, the first one should be chanted (read)now.]

Blessed are the pure in heart, * for they shall see God.

Blessed are the peacemakers, * for they shall be called the sons of God.

Blessed are they which are persecuted for righteousness' sake, * for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

Blessed are ye, when men shall revile you, and persecute you, * and shall say all manner of evil against you falsely, for my sake.

Rejoice, and be exceeding glad, * for great is your reward in the heavens.

Glory to the Father, * and to the Son, * and to the Holy Spirit.

[The second to the last troparion should be chanted (read)now.]

Both now and ever, * and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

[The last troparion should be chanted (read)now.]

Entry Hymn

O come let us worship and fall down before Christ, [Who rose from the dead,] * O Son of God, save us who sing to Thee: Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia.

**The hymn above, is called “O come let us worship”. Many Orthodox hymns are named by the first couple words. The only part of the hymn which changes is the part in brackets.*

On Sundays it is always “Who rose from the dead”.

During the period from Pascha until Ascension, we also use: “Who rose from the dead”

Outside of the Pascha period, on weekdays we sing: “Who art wondrous in the saints”, unless it is a feast of the Theotokos, in which case we sing “Through the prayers of the Theotokos”.

If it is a Great Feast of The Lord (for instance, Nativity of the Lord, or Theophany, or Transfiguration, and others), we sing the appointed Entry Verse, or “Introit”. This will be completely different and replace “O come let us worship.”

This entry verse will be found in the specific materials for that feast. Most of the time this is in the “Menaion”, which contains all of the special parts that change for any commemoration throughout the year that has a fixed date during the year. For instance, the Nativity of the Lord is always on December 25 on the church calendar, which is January 7 of the civil calendar area all of the special changes for the services for that feast are in the Menaion on that date.

Troparia

[The appointed Troparia of the day]

Trisagion*

**When “as many as have been baptized...” or “Before Thy Cross...” are appointed, they are sung in place of the Trisagion.*

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

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Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy Mighty, Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen. Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

Holy God, Holy mighty, Holy Immortal have mercy on us.

Prokimena

[The prokimena, as appointed by the Typikon]

Epistle

Reader: The reading is from the Epistle of ...

Reader reads the appropriate Epistle (epistles)

The Alleluia Verses

Then the verses are read and the choir sings Alleluia in the appropriate tone, as at a liturgy

Reader: Alleluia in the ...Tone: ...

If there are 3 alleluia verses, the Reader intone the first one. If only two, the reader waits for the choir's response

Choir: Alleluia, Alleluia, Alleluia!

Reader intones the rest of the alleluia verses, with the choir responding each time.

The Gospel

Reader: *The Reading is from the Holy Gospel according to St. _____.*

Choir: Glory to Thee, O Lord, Glory to Thee!

The Reader reads the appropriate Gospel selection(s) in a normal voice.

Choir: Glory to Thee, O Lord, Glory to Thee!

Choir: *[In the 6th Sticheron Tone]*

Remember us, O Lord, when Thou comest in Thy kingdom.

Remember us, O Master, when Thou comest in Thy kingdom.

Remember us, O Holy One, when Thou comest in Thy kingdom.

The heavenly choir praiseth Thee and saith: Holy, Holy, Holy, Lord of Sabaoth; heaven and earth are full of Thy glory.

Stichos: Come unto Him, and be enlightened and your faces shall not be ashamed.

The heavenly choir praiseth Thee and saith: Holy, Holy, Holy, Lord of Sabaoth; heaven and earth are full of Thy glory.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.

The choir of Holy angels and archangels, with all the heavenly hosts praiseth Thee and saith: Holy, Holy, Holy, Lord of Sabaoth; heaven and earth are full of Thy glory.

In plain chant:

Both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

The Creed

Note: This may be sung to a melody of the choir director's choosing, or simply read

I believe in one God, the Father Almighty, / Maker of heaven and earth and of all things visible and invisible. / And in one Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of God, / the Only-begotten, begotten of the Father before all ages; / Light of Light, true God of true God; / begotten, not made; of one essence with the Father, by Whom all things were made; / Who for us men and for our salvation came down from the heavens, / and was incarnate of the Holy Spirit and the Virgin Mary, and became man; / And was crucified for us under Pontius Pilate, / and suffered and was buried; / And arose again on the third day according to the Scriptures; / And ascended into the heavens, and sitteth at the right hand of the Father; / And shall come again, with glory, to judge both the living and the dead; / Whose kingdom shall have no end. / And in the Holy Spirit, the Lord, the Giver of life; Who proceedeth from the Father; / Who with the Father and the Son together is worshipped and glorified; Who spake by the prophets. / In One, Holy, Catholic, and Apostolic Church. / I confess one baptism for the remission of sins. / I look for the resurrection of the dead, / and the life of the age to come. Amen.

Reader: Remit, pardon, forgive, O God, our offenses, both voluntary and involuntary, in deed and word, in knowledge and ignorance, by day and by night, in mind and thought; forgive us all things, for Thou art good and the Lover of mankind.

Choir: Our Father, Who art in the heavens, hallowed be Thy name. Thy kingdom come, Thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.

Senior Reader: **O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God, have mercy on us.**

Choir: Amen.

Kontakia

[As appointed by the Typikon]

Reader: Lord, have mercy. (x12)

O All-Holy Trinity, the consubstantial dominion, the indivisible Kingdom, and cause of every Good: Show Thy good will even unto me a sinner; make steadfast my heart and grant it understanding, and take away mine every defilement; enlighten my mind that I may glorify, hymn, worship, and say:

Choir: One is Holy, One is Lord, Jesus Christ, to the Glory of God the Father. Amen.

Reader: Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Psalm 33

Note: This may be sung, or simply read.

I will bless the Lord at all times, * His praise shall continually be in my mouth. * In the Lord shall my soul be praised; * let the meek hear and be glad.

O magnify the Lord with me, * and let us exalt His name together. * I sought the Lord, and He heard me, * and delivered me from all my tribulations.

Come unto Him, and be enlightened, * and your faces shall not be ashamed. * This poor man cried, and the Lord heard him, * and saved him out of all his tribulations.

The angel of the Lord will encamp round about them that fear Him, * and will deliver them. * O taste and see that the Lord is good; * blessed is the man that hopeth in Him.

O fear the Lord, all ye His saints; * for there is no want to them that fear Him. * Rich men have turned poor and gone hungry; * but they that seek the Lord shall not be deprived of any good thing.

Come ye children, hearken unto me; * I will teach you the fear of the Lord. * What man is there that desireth life, * who loveth to see good days?

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Keep thy tongue from evil, * and thy lips from speaking guile. * Turn away from evil, and do good; * seek peace, and pursue it.

The eyes of the Lord are upon the righteous, * and His ears are opened unto their supplication. * The face of the Lord is against them that do evil, * utterly to destroy the remembrance of them from the earth.

The righteous cried, and the Lord heard them, * and He delivered them out of all their tribulations. * The Lord is high unto them that are of a contrite heart, * and He will save the humble of spirit. *

Many are the tribulations of the righteous, * and the Lord shall deliver them out of them all. * The Lord keepeth all their bones, * not one of them shall be broken.

The death of sinners is evil, * and they that hate the righteous shall do wrong. * The Lord will redeem the souls of His servants, * and none of them will do wrong that hope in Him.

Megalynarion

Note: When appointed on feast days, the appointed Zadostoinik can be sung instead of “It is truly meet...” During Great Lent, or any other time the liturgy of St. Basil would be appointed, “All creation rejoices in Thee...” may also be sung.

It is truly meet to bless thee, the Theotokos, ever-blessed and most blameless, and Mother of Our God. More honorable than the Cherubim, and beyond compare more glorious than the Seraphim, who without corruption gavest birth to God the Word, the very Theotokos, thee do we magnify.

The following is only sung in the liturgy of St. Basil the Great:

In thee rejoiceth, O thou who art full of grace, all creation, the angelic assembly, and the race of man; O sanctified temple and noetical paradise, praise of virgins, of whom God was incarnate, and became a child, He that was before the ages, even our God; for of thy body a throne He made, and thy womb more spacious than the heavens did He form. In thee rejoiceth, O thou who art full of grace, all creation: glory to thee.

Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, both now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Lord, have mercy. *(Thrice)*

O Lord, Bless.

Senior Reader (*Facing the East, rather than facing the people*):

If it be Sunday: Thou that didst rise from the dead, O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God, for the sake of the prayers of Thy most pure Mother, of our holy and God-bearing fathers, of _____ (*The Patron of the Temple*), of _____ (*saints of the day*), and all the saints, have mercy on us and save us, for Thou art good and the Lover of mankind.

If not: O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God, for the sake of the prayers of Thy most pure Mother, of our holy and God-bearing fathers, of _____ (*The Patron of the Temple*), of _____ (*saints of the day*), and all the saints, have mercy on us and save us, for Thou art good and the Lover of mankind.

Choir: Amen.

At this point the Synaxarion, or some other edifying material may be read. Then, while the people come up to venerate the Cross and the Gospel, and then to partake of some holy water and prosphora, the choir may sing.

Our Great Lord and Father Kyrill, /
the Most-holy Patriarch of Moscow and All Russia; /
our Lord the Very Most Reverend Hilarion; /
First Hierarch of the Russian Church Abroad, /
and our Lord the Most Reverend Bishop Peter; /
the brotherhood of this holy temple, /
and all Orthodox Christians: //
preserve, O Lord, for many years.

Lord, have mercy. *Thrice*